

Mahabharata ma-haa-bhaa-rut

Pandavas pawn-doves

Subhadra sue-bud-rah

On the 13th day of the battle, the Kauravas had arranged their army in a deadly chakravyuh battle formation. A well-designed chakravyuh is an Archimedes Spiral ([Figure 15.1](#)) that is virtually impossible to penetrate. The Kaurava chakravyuh was wreaking havoc on the Pandava army, and their leadership was very worried about the staggering human losses they were facing.

At this point, the story goes into a 16-year flashback when Lord Krishna was explaining to his pregnant sister, Subhadra, how a chakravyuh could be successfully penetrated all the way to its center. If one can break through and enter a chakravyuh, traverse it to its core, and finally exit, it is very effective at neutralizing the enemy's leadership at its very center—leading to mass panic and disarray among the rank and file. This is easier said than done. Such a traversal is thought to be virtually impossible.

[Figure 15.1](#) The Chakravyuh Battle Formation

